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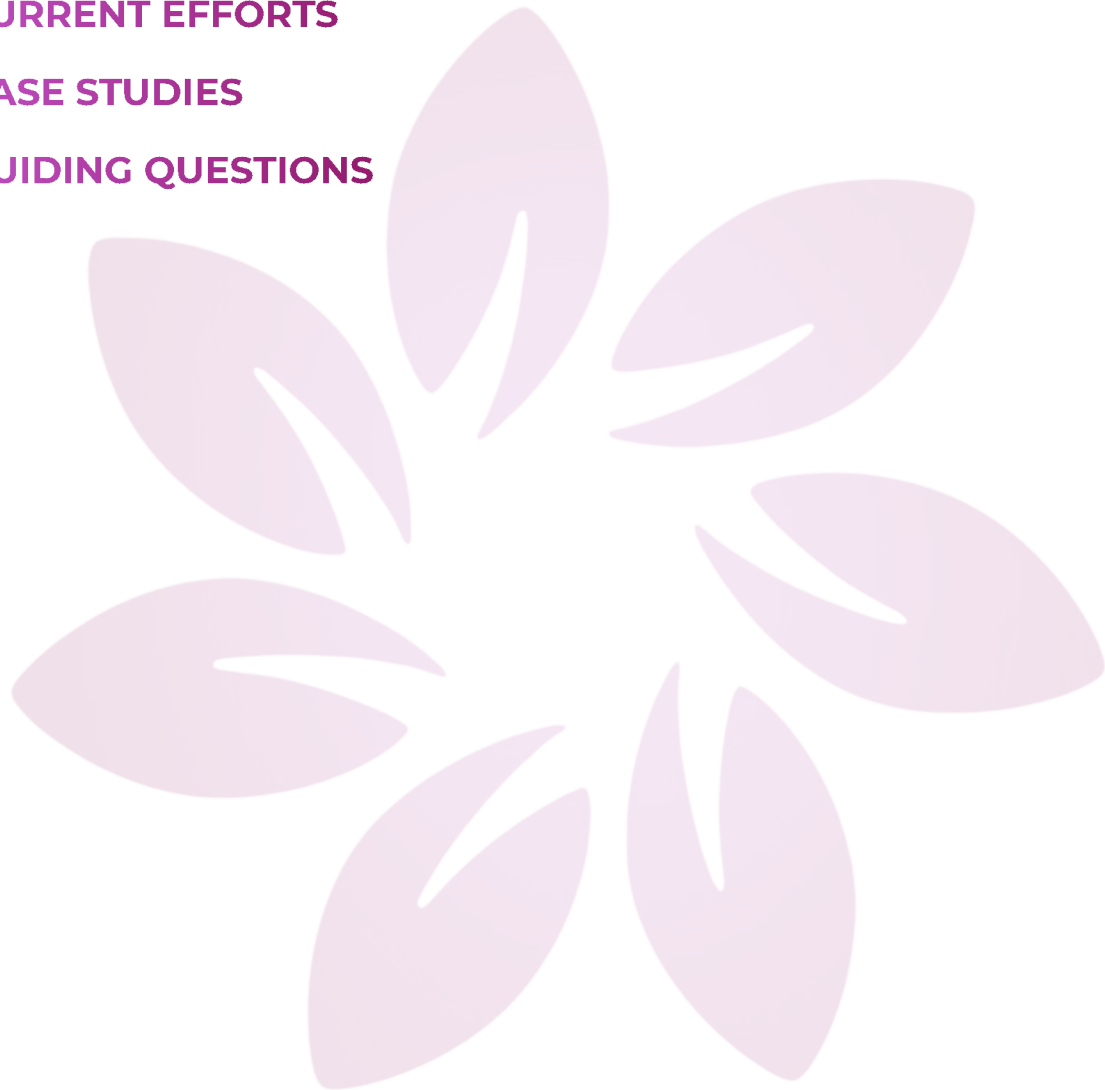
STUDY GUIDE

**1.Regulating AI-Generated
Deepfakes and Image-
Based Exploitation
Targeting Women and Girls.**



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1. INTRODUCTION TO THE TOPIC

<https://toloka.ai/blog/difference-between-ai-ml-llm-and-generative-ai/>

<https://www.tableau.com/data-insights/ai/history>

<https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2024/1689/oj/eng>

<https://artificialintelligenceact.eu/high-level-summary/>

<https://www.securityhero.io/about/>

<https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S2949882125000295>

2. AI DEFINITION & EVOLUTION

To understand the threat Artificial Intelligence (AI) may pose to women and girls when unregulated, one must understand the different types of AI models accessible to the public and their respective dangers, as well as be aware of what precisely it is. AI is broadly defined as a field of computer science concerned with the development of systems capable of performing tasks conventionally requiring human intelligence, such as natural language processing, planning and decision making. The most prevalent types, due to their relative accessibility and ease of use, are Large Language Models (LLMs), which comprehend and generate human-like language as a result of being trained on large amounts of text. Most LLMs are limited to generating text, though some newer multimodal models can also produce images or audio. Generative AI models are capable of generating text, visual or audio content that didn't previously exist based on the user's command. Generative AI can also manipulate existing media according to user's wishes, changing the original image or video with variable quality.

Visual content that has been tampered with is commonly referred to as a deepfake, yet there is no universally agreed legal definition of a deepfake. However, European Union AI Act provides a definition, according to which “‘deep fake’ means AI-generated or manipulated image, audio or video content that resembles existing persons, objects, places, entities or events and would falsely appear to a person to be authentic or truthful”. Once a deepfake is produced, it can be replicated endlessly, and is nearly impossible to remove, similarly to all other types of digital footprint.

Although AI dates back to the mid-twentieth century and becomes increasingly available to society with each passing decade, the true “explosion” is dated back to 2022 when ChatGPT, primarily strictly LLM, was launched to the mass audience. The ease of use and speed of the results drew in massive numbers of users, generating huge volumes of data that could be used to further train the models through Machine Learning, which are a set of techniques by which systems improve at a task by learning patterns from data rather than being explicitly programmed with rules for it. This surge in activity paved the way for AI to develop into what we know today.

- **AI gender bias**

According to the official UN statistics, over a billion of people use AI for everyday tasks, even if they do so unconsciously. Private companies and governmental structures utilize it as a means of increasing efficiency. An issue that numerous studies have underscored is the bias in AI’s decision making and task execution rooted in sexist sentiments from training data the model was trained on, reflecting the historical systemic, unfair difference in the treatment of women and men, favouring the latter. Moreover, racist biases have been documented as well. An alarming statistic of only 24 from 138 assessed countries by UN Women, referenced gender in their national AI strategies depicts the policy gap that is purposely left ignored.

!Furthermore, only 30% of the AI workforce identifies as female, the percentage decreasing exponentially to decision-making power, which raises concerns whether AI reflects diverse perspective. There are speculations associating the aforementioned ratio of gender in AI-related jobs as one of the root causes of AI's prejudice.

- **weaponization of deepfakes against women**

<https://www.unwomen.org/en/articles/explainer/when-justice-fails-why-women-cant-get-protection-from-ai-deepfake-abuse>

Security Hero, a startup conducting research of safe online practices, released a study called “2023 State of Deepfakes” finding that 98% of deepfakes were pornographic visual content, and 99% of these AI-generated images, videos and pictures depicted women. One in three deepfake tools allow for sexual content creation, and most worrying information is that up to the year 2023 when said research was released,

74% of surveyed deepfake pornography users felt no remorse over consuming or generating it.

Less than a half of UN Member States have laws addressing online abuse, and even fewer specifically address deepfakes as a variety of it. Therefore, perpetrators can easily find loopholes in the policies if they're ever prosecuted, creating difficulties for victims. Platforms allowing users to create deepfakes are frequently unwilling to share data with law enforcement or cooperate with the victim seeking justice. Distance from the survivor and the abuser contributes to the difficulty of seeking retribution due to cross-border cases being profoundly more complicated.

Another issue to consider is underreporting. Victims are obliged to show the humiliating content to platform moderators or police officers, who must watch at least a portion of it to decide whether it in fact is abuse. Women's credibility is questioned more often than not in justice systems. Their previous relationships, life decisions and actions are dissected in court for anyone to hear, causing severe emotional distress. As a result, a common response is simply reporting a post and removing oneself from the platform, allowing the harasser to repeat their offense in the future. Research suggests that 7 out of 10 of the most popular pornography sites host deepfake porn with little to no verification.

3. CURRENT EFFORTS

to combat the issue of insufficient regulation of AI systems

Due to AI systems being an objectively new development spreading rapidly, no comprehensive global legal framework yet exists, although some efforts have been noticed. Thus far, most of the policies follow the findings of AI ethics' boards, which are accountable for researching how to develop and utilize AI in a way that is fair, accountable, transparent, and respects human values. The practice is also known as AI compliance. One of the most pressing concerns are the harmful outcomes of exploitation or uninformed use, therefore the guidelines must focus on ensuring transparency, data privacy and safety for the users, as well as eliminating bias and unfairness when used by companies to manage the multitude. Many governments criminalised Non-Consensual Intimate Images (NCII) involving real images,

but none of them extended these laws to cover AI-generated deepfakes up until 2024. However, there have been significant efforts exponentially increasing in quantity since.

Approaches to creating such legal frameworks regulating AI companies and the technology's development, deployment and use vary largely within the UN Member States. For instance, the USA believes in minimal regulation so as not to restrict development although state-level legislation is instated, whilst China pushes for innovation whilst maintaining strict surveillance of authorities. The Member States which are also a member of the European Union universally apply policies proposed by the European Commission. One of such laws was the EU AI Act, proposed by the European Commission in 2021, the world's first comprehensive uniform legal framework governing AI systems, which began phased enforcement in 2024. Under it, AI is categorized according to the risk it may pose to individuals or governments, followed by a tier-specific set of regulations. The majority of obligations fall on the developers and deployers (who enable AI use in professional capacity), penalizing only the aforementioned authorities. The act was created with corporations in mind, so that obligations sit with providers, whilst individual citizens using AI for personal reasons are mostly not to be prosecuted.

An accentuation that must be made is that all these three approaches favor the authority of the developers over their own products rather than strict national oversight, which proves that legislation does not mean to halt progress, but simply ensures shelter to individuals.

4. CASE STUDIES

Algeria

<https://cms.law/en/int/expert-guides/cms-expert-guide-to-data-protection-and-cyber-security-laws/algeria2>

<https://www.ipu.org/impact/democracy-and-strong-parliaments/artificial-intelligence/parliamentary-actions-ai-policy#>

The Algerian Penal Code punishes defamation, insult, and invasion of privacy, but

none of them yet name deepfakes as a crime. Law 18-07 protects personal data of individuals against conservation, modification or extraction, allowing prosecution of perpetrators who commit crimes utilizing technology to harass people online under the National Authority for the Protection of Personal Data.

In 2024, Algeria introduced an amendment to the Cybercrime Law, strengthening policies against digital crimes. It relates to offenses committed using information and communication technologies. Therefore, Algeria already permits victims of online abuse to seek justice through law enforcement, enabling a simplified process of potentially including deepfakes in an amendment to the law, rather than having the parliament create it ab initio. Furthermore, parliament is expected to consider a bill which has not been fully drafted at the moment. It would establish ethical and security standards across stages of AI R&D, devising an era where the Algerian government has tools to fight cybercrime committed using generative AI.

Although Algeria is one of the few countries where the distribution of imagery without the participant's consent is punishable by law, the issues common for the female population worldwide, such as underreporting due to shame, are prevalent. The AI-generated media thus far has not been legally defined, therefore it is an area where perpetrators may easily escape justice.

In June 2025, the Algerian National People's Assembly discussed the aforementioned modern offense. An emphasis was put on the need to strengthen penalties for abuse in line with the abilities of technology to be exploited. One of the key findings of the debate was the necessity of establishing a regulatory framework that would align with international standards, whilst simultaneously protecting its own citizens.

Argentina

<https://www.ipu.org/news/news-in-brief/2026-06/ipu-urges-parliaments-act-ai-drivensexual-deepfakes>

<https://www.ipu.org/impact/democracy-and-strong-parliaments/artificial-intelligence/p-arliamentary-actions-ai-policy#>

Argentina has struggled with AI-generated media wreaking havoc in mass

media. It has become a tool for spreading misinformation, as was the case during the 2023

Presidential elections, targeting individuals even amongst teenagers and enabling cybercrime with few legally defined punishable offences, Argentina does not penalize the generation of deepfakes as they are not legally defined by criminal statutes. However, the digital, privacy and mental health laws provide sufficient ground for lawyers to advocate for the victims who chose to report online abuse.

Despite the hypothetical existing legal path towards justice for deepfakes victims, Argentina's National Congress has made noticeable efforts to regulate artificial intelligence technologies similarly to other attempts internationally.

It has been done so by proposing the obligation of providers to regulate consumers (bill no.7045), the establishment of Federal Observatories on AI (bill no.3900) or a committee monitoring the comprehensive use of AI (bill no.2405), alongside bills preventing the misuse, AI governance, legal framework creation (bill no.2130) and even ones penalizing criminal activities involving AI systems such as spreading misinformation with emphasis on deepfakes. Resolutions following the introductions of these bills are being discussed within the parliament.

Argentina has also created a federal agency aimed at ensuring security by enhanced surveillance, called the Unit for Artificial Intelligence Applied to Security (UIAAS), which deploys AI technologies as a security measure.

Australia

<https://dcj.nsw.gov.au/legal-and-justice/laws-and-legislation/image-based-abuse.html>

[https://www.ipu.org/impact/democracy-and-strong-parliaments/artificial-intelligence/p arliamentary-actions-ai-policy#](https://www.ipu.org/impact/democracy-and-strong-parliaments/artificial-intelligence/p%20arliamentary-actions-ai-policy#)

<https://www.whitecase.com/insight-our-thinking/ai-watch-global-regulatory-tracker-australia>

Professor Nicola Henry, a scholar at RMIT University in Melbourne fully supports the complete ban on AI-generated pornographic material. In 2023, he ran a survey which showed that Australia's rate of deepfake victims is higher by 1.5% than the

world average. According to official data, 99% of deepfake porn victims are women, and only up to 10% of deepfakes do not belong in the NCII category.

In 2024, Australia established the Select Committee on Adopting Artificial Intelligence which is responsible for the investigation and reporting on the potential of AI, both opportunities and perils it brings. The committee's final report included introducing legislation regulating high-risk AI, enhancing support to further develop AI models, protecting worker's rights following the adoption of AI technologies in private companies and weighing the environmental impact of AI infrastructure on Australia's natural ecosystems.

Another inquiry was made by the government the same year, focusing on the use of AI in public-sector institutions. The key findings were primarily inconsistencies, lack of sufficient transparency in AI's decision-making processes, which is a phenomenon referred to as the "black box" and prompted the authorities to establish an oversight committee dedicated to the topic.

The Criminal Code Amendment (Deepfake Sexual Material) Act of 2024, criminalising the manipulation of sexual images, which carries a maximum penalty of seven years in prison, allowed for the perpetrators prosecution. Both federal and state jurisdictions introduced specific regulations on AI-generated sexually explicit material in order to protect women and girls. The legislation follows a wave of deepfakes impacting high-profile figures, such as politicians, artists and voice actors facing job displacement due to AI cloning and gender-based online abuse. Australian law regarding obligations around privacy, consumer protection, discrimination, workplace safety and intellectual property apply to all technologies. Due to their presence, the officials do not see a necessity to create a separate body specifically for AI purposes, although Guidance for AI Adoption is considered the blueprint for artificial intelligence technologies governance. In July 2026, the Government announced plans for a legislated national framework covering large data centres and AI training. The proposed standards would include mandatory energy and water requirements for large AI data centres.

Brazil

<https://dfrlab.org/2024/11/26/brazil-election-ai-deepfakes/>

[https://www.ipu.org/impact/democracy-and-strong-parliaments/artificial-intelligence/p arliamentary-actions-ai-policy#](https://www.ipu.org/impact/democracy-and-strong-parliaments/artificial-intelligence/p%20arliamentary-actions-ai-policy#)

<https://www.whitecase.com/insight-our-thinking/ai-watch-global-regulatory-tracker-br-azil>

Brazil has faced multiple scandals caused strictly by deepfakes targeting individuals, as is the trend worldwide, but also during the 2024 municipal elections. AI-generated pictures of candidates being portrayed as, for instance, communists, had flooded Brazilian media. Yet these caricatures were not the only deepfakes presented to the public. Videos of politicians supposedly voicing their support for a specific contestant, manufactured evidence of crime and misleading regarding information crucial to the elections, such as dates of rallies. The TSE Resolution 23.732/2024 states that all AI-generated content in electoral campaigns must be disclosed and prohibits deepfakes usage during election periods.

Following these incidents, Brazil's senate approved AI Bill 2,338/2023, which created a risk-based framework similar to the one imposed by the EU AI Act, but it is not law until it has been voted upon in the House of Representatives and approved by the president. Regulations affecting AI include Law No. 13,709/2018, Law No. 8,078/1990 and Law No. 9,610/1998. The scope of proposed regulations is nationwide, without any distinction between national and foreign entities nor sector-specific focus.

The Proposed AI Regulation aims to create reliable systems advantageous to individuals and protect fundamental rights. It categorizes AI systems according to risk-tiers and specifies that a risk classification must be conducted prior to the model being placed on the market.

China

<https://www.ipu.org/impact/democracy-and-strong-parliaments/artificial-intelligence/parliamentary-actions-ai-policy#> <https://regulations.ai/regulations/china-summary>

<https://www.whitecase.com/insight-our-thinking/ai-watch-global-regulatory-tracker-china>

The current government is known for its strict state regulation over the Chinese and censorship legislation. The “Great Firewall of China” is a programme meant to protect citizens with access to the internet. Banning the production and distribution of pornography back in 1997 ensures that deepfake AI porn, so prevalent worldwide, does not need a separate set of regulations restricting it, as the creation or

distribution of pornographic material, whether manufactured or not, is an offense. Therefore, women in China are seemingly protected in comparison with those who do not possess

Chinese citizenship, yet meaningful protection remains limited, as defamation and rumors, while technically criminalized, are rarely prosecuted unless the victim pursues the case themselves.

China's online spaces, however, are flooding with artificially generated content targeting public figures. The recreational use of this content and accessibility to create is causing it to struggle with one of the world's most extensive AI use problems, which it is currently attempting to tackle. According to Articles 253 and 291 of the Criminal Law of China, individuals or groups purposely obtaining and disseminating personal information in an attempt to disturb the public, they may face up to seven years in prison, yet deepfakes do not fall into this category. As of the moment, the law specifies that all AI-generated media shared with the public must be watermarked in a way that is visible to the consumer, therefore the responsibility is on both platforms operating in China and users.

China's AI Measures were instated in 2023, and they provide that the government will implement a "categorical and hierarchical regulation of Generative AI services", relevant departments will enhance their scientific development using AI, a classification and a grading-based supervision rules will be created. Furthermore, under the AI Measures providers of the service must ensure users utilize the model lawfully, in an informed way, label the data, comply with socialist core values, moderate any illegal content and establish reporting mechanisms.

Laws and regulations in China do not directly aim to regulate artificial intelligence per se, but their presence affects the development and use of it, examples of which are the Cybersecurity Law, the Personal Information Protection Law (the PIPL), and the Data Security Law.

Egypt

<https://regulations.ai/regulations/RAI-EG-NA-SUMMARY-2026>

<https://www.amnesty.org/en/latest/press-release/2020/08/egypt-survivors-of-sexual-violence-and-online-abuse-among-prosecuted-women-tiktok-influencers/>

In 2020, Egyptian law enforcement arrested multiple women under the pretense of “indecentcy” online on a platform named TikTok. One of these cases was a woman begging the public to help her legally prosecute men who raped her, who would later meet specific fate for “inciting debauchery”. Human-rights organisations argue that the Egyptian government not only silences female survivors, but also permits the spread of gender-based abuse, which spills into online spaces. A 2022 study showed that 50.3% of its participants reported technology facilitated sexual abuse (TFSV), yet only 3.9% reported those incidents to a law-enforcement agency. There is currently no deepfake harassment data provided by the government or credible research.

Egypt’s regulatory approach to artificial intelligence is proactive and state-led, emphasising ethical use whilst maintaining innovation. In 2021, the National AI Strategy and its update in 2025, considers AI a technology that would benefit the entirety of the society and remain inclusive to all. A bill drafted in 2024 aimed at protecting citizens from the misuse of AI is still being reviewed. A law protecting children and minors is currently being discussed as well.

FRANCE

<https://www.ipu.org/impact/democracy-and-strong-parliaments/artificial-intelligence/parliamentary-actions-ai-policy#>

<https://www.whitecase.com/insight-our-thinking/ai-watch-global-regulatory-tracker-france>

France has seen rising concerns about AI-generated deepfakes and image-based sexual abuse against women and girls, as increasingly accessible generative AI makes it easier to create and distribute sexually explicit imagery without consent. The response has seen a combination of existing privacy and image-protection laws, as well as new legislation specifically targeting algorithmically generated content. Under Article 226-8 of the French Criminal Code, the non-consensual dissemination of a manipulated image or audio representing a person not clearly identified as such is a punishable offence, with harsher penalties in the case of online dissemination. More importantly, France introduced Article 226-8-1 with Law No. 2024-449 of 21 May 2024, which criminalises the dissemination of sexual content manipulated or algorithmically generated content reproducing a person's image or words without their consent with a sentence of two years' imprisonment and a €60,000 fine. The

sentence increases to three years' imprisonment and a €75,000 fine if the material is published through an online public communication service.

France's response thus combines national criminal law with wider European digital regulation, including the EU Digital Services Act and the EU AI Act. The DSA creates notice-and-action mechanisms for illegal content while adding extra obligations for large online platforms to address systemic risks, while the AI Act introduces transparency requirements around AI-generated and manipulated content, including deepfakes. France's regulatory framework further relies on national digital and data-protection authorities to mitigate online harms and enforce European rules. However, there are still significant challenges, mainly the prevention of the creation of synthetic sexual imagery, as Article 226-8-1 criminalises acts of making such material available to the public or a third party rather than all forms of private creation. The rapid development of nudification applications, the ability of perpetrators to act anonymously or across borders, the difficulty of securing rapid removal of content from multiple platforms, and the continued need for effective protection and support for victims all show that criminalisation alone cannot be the sole answer to AI-generated image-based exploitation. France's experience thus demonstrates the importance of combined criminal penalties, platform accountability, rapid removal mechanisms, technological safeguards and victim-support measures.

Germany

<https://www.ipu.org/impact/democracy-and-strong-parliaments/artificialintelligence/parliamentary-actions-ai-policy#>

<https://www.whitecase.com/insight-our-thinking/ai-watch-global-regulatory-tracker-germany>

Germany is witnessing a significant rise in AI-generated Non-Consensual Deepfake Explicit Imagery targeting women and teenage girls, which was highlighted in reported cases involving students using consumer AI tools to create and share sexualised deepfake images of classmates. The problem stems from the lack of consumer AI tools regulation in traditional statutes such as section 184k of the German Criminal Code (StGB) that punish upskirting and other physical photo violations but does not explicitly mention fully synthesized or AI-modified images where a visual privacy infringement is absent, as the creation of sexualised

deepfakes is not generally criminalised under current German law, jurisdictional delays in obtaining civil injunctions, and the platforms' difficulties in addressing synthetic media as non-consensual sexual violence. Germany has responded to the controversy with a multi-layered governance legal approach that combined existing national criminal law with ongoing proposed criminal-law reforms and EU-level legislation and regulations, including proposals to introduce new criminal-law provisions addressing harmful deepfakes, rather than completed amendments to sections 184 and 201a of the StGB, the EU Digital Services Act imposing notice-and-action takedown procedures on hosting services, including online platforms, the EU AI Act transparency obligations for AI-generated media, and the Federal Network Agency oversight as the national Digital Services Coordinator. Though the reforms and civil-society initiatives have provided avenues for legal assistance and support to victims, including through organisations such as HateAid, which could secure legal remedies such as preliminary injunctions for the deepfake abuse victims, significant gaps remain in the current framework, namely jurisdictional challenges over offshore platforms, the appearance of synthetic nudification apps and the difficulty of effectively identifying and investigating anonymous deepfake creators.

India

<https://english.elpais.com/international/2026-08-15/ai-fueles-a-surge-in-online-abuseagainst-women-in-india-it-felt-like-someone-had-taken-control-of-how-i-exist-visually.html>

<https://thebulletin.org/2026/01/disinformation-and-deepfakes-improving-crisis-communications-in-india-and-pakistan/>

<https://www.whitecase.com/insight-our-thinking/ai-watch-global-regulatory-tracker-india>

India's digital landscape is currently shaped by artificial intelligence technologies, and with no official legislation around it, may enable AI abuse. Consequently, convincing deepfakes and cloning are used to target women for the sole purpose of providing entertainment through harassment, humiliation and sexual exploitation. The Center for Countering Digital Hate found that Grok generated approximately three million sexualized images in just 11 days. Even before AI became accessible to the general public, current perpetrators used platforms such as Sulli Deals and Bulli Bai to harass women without their consent or knowledge of the activity.

India's Information Technology Act (IT Act) requires platforms to remove NCII and the proposed Digital India Act (which has remained a draft since 2023) authorizes law enforcement to impose fines up to 500 crore rupees on platforms which do not remove NCII. However, the law is not enforced properly and scarcely any action is taken under it. With that exception, there are no specific laws or regulations in India directly governing AI, nor is there even a legally recognized definition of what artificial intelligence is. There are certain frameworks implemented in the financial and healthcare sectors, setting guidelines for responsible, ethical use and inclusive nationwide adaptation of AI practices. India seeks to use the potential this technology offers to provide an environment suitable for its further development. The AI Governance Guidelines categorize risks posed by audio-visual generated content into six categories. India's Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology is the executive agency for AI-related strategies and its current focus is amending the IT Act and drafting the aforementioned AI Governance Guidelines.

Japan

<https://mainichi.jp/english/articles/20251105/p2a/00m/0op/021000c>

<https://www.japantimes.co.jp/news/2026/08/05/japan/crime-legal/child-sexual-deepfakes-double/>

<https://www.whitecase.com/insight-our-thinking/ai-watch-global-regulatory-tracker-japan>

Japan Publicity Right Protection Organization (JAPRO) conducted a study which revealed that billions of yen has been lost in copyright and revenue as a result of unregulated AI-generated celebrity content. The very same tactic is also being used to sway the public during the election periods, but also spread misinformation and cause civilians to question official institutions. For instance, upon the debate regarding the consumption tax and rising prices, posts online suggested abolishing the Children and Family Agency, which funds nursery schools, childcare leave benefits and child allowances, in order to “free up” 7.3 trillion yen and provide that money to newborn children.

The National Police Agency has stated that the number of cases involving child sexual abuse material (CSAM) has doubled in the first half of 2026. In 83 cases, the suspected perpetrators were classmates or students attending the same school as the victims.

Japan Penal Code criminalizes defamation and all violations of the Act on Punishment of Activities Relating to Child Prostitution and Child Pornography. The AI generated imagery that isn't a hyper-realistic manufactured real image of a child falls into the legal grey zone and the perpetrator may not be prosecuted for that offense. The government has indicated the intention to address the crisis, yet no formal laws have been enacted. Conversely, local authorities have taken steps to protect their people. The Tottori Prefectural Government enacted an ordinance to regulate sexual deepfakes, under which the names of those creating the CSAM are to be publicly disclosed should they not comply with the law enforcement. No further steps have been made on the national level.

What must not be omitted is Japan's aim to become a leading global AI center, where the most developed models are thriving. All sorts of regulations may interfere with the goal, hence the hesitancy in building a legal framework. Another key factor in Japan's widespread deepfake distribution is the massive scale of bullying, and classmates use AI-generated content as a means of humiliation they've become desensitized to. Therefore, the most prominent efforts of combating the issue are currently awareness campaigns educating people on the consequences.

Nigeria

<https://www.ipu.org/impact/democracy-and-strong-parliaments/artificial-intelligence/parliamentary-actions-ai-policy#>

<https://nass.gov.ng/documents/download/11175>

<https://www.whitecase.com/insight-our-thinking/ai-watch-global-regulatory-tracker-nigeria>

Nigeria is one of the most developed countries in Africa, but traditional values centered around misogyny and patriarchy remain widespread even in the twenty-first century. Gender-based violence, isolated cases of honour killings and domestic femicide may not be common, but they happen far too frequently to be dismissed. Sexual exploitation online, through coercion and other tactics used by abusers is itself underreported caused by the fear of being publicly shamed and humiliated, therefore the deepfake crisis statistics are even more unreliable. The Cybercrimes Prohibition Act legally limits access to pornography, the severity of the ban depending on the state. The Child Rights Act protects children from any forms of online abuse anticipated by the legislation's authors. Nonetheless, Nigeria does not remain helpless against the threat of

artificially generated media, and instead has taken actions on a national and international level. The Nigeria Data Protection Act of 2023 regulates accountability and transparency for private entities and companies, as well as data protection. It also established the Nigeria Data Protection Commission, which maintains surveillance over online safety of Nigerian citizens. There are plans of launching a National Artificial Intelligence Strategy monitoring AI development and deployment, alongside supervising all internet spaces by implementing laws such as E-Governance Bill.

Nigeria's government has taken multiple measures to ensure AI safety and general security of its citizens. Nonetheless, the corruption omnipresent amongst the authorities situates the country as one who is struggling with maintaining a clear front.

South Korea

<https://www.whitecase.com/insight-our-thinking/ai-watch-global-regulatory-tracker-south-korea>

The Republic of South Korean has specific regulations and frameworks regarding AI, most of them being specified in the Basic Act on the Development of Artificial Intelligence and the Establishment of Foundation for Trustworthiness ("AI Act"). The AI Act entered into force together with the Presidential "Enforcement Decree" in January 2026. Key provisions include domestic representative designation in cases of a foreign AI operator, setting the computation threshold at 1026 FLOPS and generative AI obligations around the form and content available to users. South Korea legislation incorporates laws potentially impacting AI usage via amendments, the most prominent of which are the Copyright Act, Fair Hiring Procedure Act, Personal Information Protection Act and Public Official Election Act. The AI act defines AI and differentiates Generative Artificial Intelligence and High-impact Artificial Intelligence.

South Korea's AI regulation focuses on fostering innovation whilst maintaining safety by creating a legal foundation for the "AI Ethical Principles" to protect human rights and dignity, developing an AI plan and forming a National AI Committee overseen by the President.

Compliance requirements oblige the providers to obey the AI Act and notify users of relevant products or services available to them in the app.

Currently, there are 5 regulatory bodies in South Korea with analogous responsibilities in distinct sectors. MSIT, one of the bodies, has the authority to investigate non-compliant providers and impose corrective penalties if needed, although a one-year grace period is granted to support effective, thorough implementation of the new rules.

Russian Federation

<https://iknowpolitics.org/en/news/ai-generated-deepfakes-targeting-women-politicians-around-world>

Russia has a general negative approach to artificial intelligence technology within its borders. Seeing as AI-generated media presenting situations uncontrolled by the authorities might be distributed amongst Russian heavily censored media, undermining the current image Moscow has built. However, the Kremlin has no restraints against abusing deepfake technology and Vladimir Putin implied the existence of plans to create and distribute weaponized NCII deepfakes of influential female political figures to ruin their reputations, as they pose threat to Russia's interest.

Russia has legislation limiting the use of AI and bans on pornographic media in general, therefore the issue of deepfake porn targeting women is not significantly higher than in other countries.

Saudi Arabia

<https://www.ipu.org/impact/democracy-and-strong-parliaments/artificial-intelligence/parliamentary-actions-ai-policy#S>

<https://regulations.ai/regulations/RAI-SA-NA-SUMMARY-2026>

<https://www.whitecase.com/insight-our-thinking/ai-watch-global-regulatory-tracker-saudi-arabia>

Saudi Arabia has strict restrictions on pornographic content based on the Sharia Law. Porn sites available internationally and allowing for cross-border NCII sharing are blocked within the borders of the country, making artificially generated deepfakes significantly harder to spread. Possessing or watching illicit media is penalized at times even by imprisonment, however such restrictions do not necessarily mean that this issue is completely non-existent, but still less likely. Saudi Data and AI Authority plans to make the Kingdom the global leader in artificial intelligence within the upcoming 5 years, as stated by the National Strategy for Data and Artificial Intelligence. Proposed regulatory frameworks focus on data protection and ethical principles, minimizing the risk of overuse, completing already existing laws. There are two main legal authorities on AI, the Personal Data Protection Law and the National Cybersecurity Framework, which explicitly forbid non-consensual data processing and monitor cross-border data transferring. The Generative AI Guidelines for Government and AI Adoption Framework, both made public in 2024, focus on oversight of AI development and implementation, as well as emphasise the need of watermarking artificially generated media to prevent confusion. Saudi Arabia cooperates with nations worldwide and is willing to align its policies to norms the world will set, as seen by Saudi Arabia obtaining ISO/IEC 42001 certification.

Sweden

<https://www.ipu.org/impact/democracy-and-strong-parliaments/artificial-intelligence/parliamentary-actions-ai-policy#S>

Sweden faces a growing problem of non-consensual deepfake explicit imagery of women and teenage girls and insufficient privacy protection laws which allow the sharing of explicit images without consent. The issue was triggered by a surge of AI-enabled sexually explicit imagery, which has made people question the privacy laws in Sweden, which criminalizes the distribution of non-consensual, nude pictures of individuals. However, Sweden's privacy laws do not explicitly criminalize the distribution of false images nor do they protect people against the creation of digitally manipulated images. Consequently, there has been a draft in the Swedish government to adjust the privacy laws by making the circulation of false intimate visual materials or images a form of unlawful invasion of privacy. Sweden's

approach fits within the broader European regulatory environment, which is also seeking to impose stricter rules and obligations on big tech firms due to their significant role in enabling the spread of illegal material. The European Union's Digital Services Act (DSA) requires online platforms to make it easier for users to report illegal content and imposes higher scrutiny and accountability on large "digital gatekeepers." The EU AI Act includes transparency obligations for AI-generated and manipulated content. The Swedish Post and Telecom Authority, which oversees the implementation of the Digital Services Act (DSA) in Sweden, is tasked with coordinating the response. However, several important gaps and loopholes exist in Sweden's strategy to combat deepfake pornography. Most notably, the "nudification" tools remain widely available on numerous platforms, while anonymous perpetrators can exploit jurisdictional gaps to host content on foreign soil, and the removal of content is often too slow, and explicit deepfake content can be rapidly re-uploaded on different sites and shared through messaging services and social-media platforms, thus, becoming widely available across the country within hours. As such, Sweden's experience illustrates the complexity of addressing the proliferation and accessibility of AI-generated explicit nudity and the need for enhanced cooperation among states, online platforms, law enforcement agencies, and civil society organizations to ensure a coordinated and effective response to the issue.

United Arab Emirates

<https://www.whitecase.com/insight-our-thinking/ai-watch-global-regulatory-tracker-uae>

<https://www.lw.com/en/insights/ai-in-the-uae-understanding-the-regulatory-landscapeand-key-authorities>

The United Arab Emirates comprises multiple jurisdictions, depending on each emirate, governing with its own set of Emirati laws, but all seven of them must adhere to the federal laws of UAE. The territory is generally categorized as Mainland UAE (or onshore) and Financial Free Zones, which are distinct from other areas and are tailored to support trade and development of a specific sector, as well as attract international businesses. The free zones are the Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC) and the Abu Dhabi Global Market (ADGM). Consequently, an AI framework that is universally adopted in the entirety of the country in the same way is harder to implement than in non-federal states.

The Mainland UAE uses guidelines and decrees accumulated over time since the launch of AI technologies, none of which would undermine the wish to become a leader in artificial intelligence development by 2031. In 2017, a Minister of State for AI was appointed, his responsibilities being oversight and strategic direction of AI practices on a federal level. Federal Decree Law No. 25 on the Project of Future Nature provided the Cabinet with the authority to grant licenses for the implementation of any innovative project using modern technology. Law No. (3) of 2024 Establishing the Artificial Intelligence and Advanced Technology Council (AIATC) was issued to regulate the aforementioned projects, investments and research in the emirate of Abu Dhabi.

Multiple government bodies issued non-binding national guidelines such as the Deepfake Guide, which provides measures against deepfakes and how to report them, AI ethics guide, AI Adoption Guideline in Government Services and many others, highlighting the care of the UAE to ensure AI compliance and responsible use. The Financial Free Zones chose the path of amending existing data protection legislation applying to DIFC, such as the amendment to Article 10 of the DIFC DP Regulation, but no other AI-focused regulations were instated. There are however laws somewhat restricting artificial intelligence, such as the Article 432 of the Penal Code, DIFC Law No. 4 of 2019 and the UAE Copyright Law. Additionally, the DIFC introduced stringent requirements in Section 10.2.2 of the DP Regulations for the deployers to provide clear notice of the use of AI, description of the model's purpose and principles the users must be aware of.

Current attempts at legislation in the Mainland UAE and the Financial Free Zones seek the establishment of the best practices to foster a steady development of artificial intelligence, as aimed in the UAE National Strategy for Artificial Intelligence 2031.

On the international level, the Emirates adopted the UNESCO's Recommendation on the Ethics of AI to align its practices with global norms

United Kingdom

<https://www.whitecase.com/insight-our-thinking/ai-watch-global-regulatory-tracker-uk>

<https://www.ncsc.gov.uk/frontier-ai>

The United Kingdom is significantly more reliant on everyday AI access than the vast majority of other countries. It is not only civilians using AI tools nor organizations using AI to boost efficiency, but the government has begun to openly operate with the aid of artificial intelligence.

The current restriction focus is primarily CSAM, as the numbers are alarmingly high and have been rising exponentially to the advancement of generative tools. The Crime and Policing Act of 2026, strengthened existing CSAM framework by extending existing offences to address AI forms of abuse and banning AI models optimised to generate child sexual materials. NCII, including intimate deepfakes, have also been noted by the government and proposals of new legislative measures are being drafted. The Online Safety Act 2023 has criminalized sharing, threatening to do so, alongside the Data (Use and Access) Act 2025 containing suggestions of punishing even the requests of the creation of non-consensual intimate deepfakes (Section 138). The tech companies incapable of the detection and removal of now illegal deepfake material may be fined up to 10% of their annual turnover. A well known platform, X, is currently being investigated with the intention of banning it should the pornography policies not change.

United States

<https://www.whitecase.com/insight-our-thinking/ai-watch-global-regulatory-tracker-united-states>

The US currently has no comprehensive federal AI legislation. Donald Trump's administration has taken a pro-innovation, pro-AI development stance through the Removing Barriers to American Leadership in AI (executive order), the AI Action Plan, the AI National Policy Framework and the National AI Legislative Framework. On a federal level, only one AI-specific law has been enacted, the TAKE IT DOWN Act, criminalizing the publications of NCII including AI-generated deepfakes and requiring platforms to operate a notice-and-removal process. Several states sanctioned their own laws, including the Colorado AI Act, NY RAISE Act, Texas TRAIGA and algorithmic pricing laws. Private organizations and providers of artificial intelligence technology must ensure AI compliance to state laws and monitor federal laws at all times.

The National AI Initiative Act of 2020 focused on expanding research and implementing the national AI strategy of the president in office. Besides this,

executive orders of the present president override the ones issued by the predecessor, creating a system where the approach may change completely in cycles determined by election dates. The AI Bill of Rights has not been pursued during Trump's administration, alongside Biden EO.

The specifics of each framework adopted since 2025 all have pro-innovation, deregulation and enhanced development agenda. Drafts of potential frameworks are continuously introduced to the Congress, however, none of them were enacted thus far.

The primary way of maintaining control over AI is through already established regulations, specifically privacy and intellectual property laws, which generally can be applied to artificial intelligence when needed. Both developers and users must be aware of the legislations, despite no specific obligations being imposed on any party at the moment.

5. GUIDING QUESTIONS

How can countries balance protecting people against generative AI without restricting its development?

What are the current attitudes regarding artificial intelligence?

Who should be held accountable for a deepfake?

How can deepfakes be defined, categorized or classified?

Which mechanisms can be used to protect women and girls from online abuse?

How can multilateralism be strengthened to ensure swift, unified action?

To what extent legislation may be implemented without limiting personal freedom?